

Board 1

North Deals
None Vul

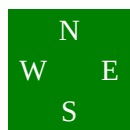
♠ J
♥ A 6 5 4 3
♦ J 10 9 4
♣ 6 5 4

♠ A Q 9 7 4

♥ 8

♦ A 6 3 2

♣ K Q J



♠ 10 3

♥ Q 9 2

♦ K Q 8 7 5

♣ 10 7 2

♠ K 8 6 5 2

♥ K J 10 7

♦ -

♣ A 9 8 3

Your 4♦ bid is a Splinter Bid, showing opening hand strength, at least 4 ♠s, and a singleton or void in ♦s. Partner bids 4NT.

You have 2 Key-Cards, the ♠K and the ♣A. So do you bid 5♥?

No. You have two Key-Cards **AND** a void. So you bid 5NT. Partner bids 6♠.

West	North	East	South
	1♠	Pass	4♦
Pass	4NT	Pass	5NT
Pass	6♠		
All Pass			
6♠ by North			

Board 2

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ A 10 8
 ♥ K 9 8 4
 ♦ K 9
 ♣ K 10 6 5

♠ 9 7 6 5 4

♥ Q 5

♦ 10 5 2

♣ A 7 2

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♠ K Q J
 ♥ A 10 7 6
 ♦ A Q J
 ♣ Q J 9

♠ 3 2

♥ J 3 2

♦ 8 7 6 4 3

♣ 8 4 3

West	North	East	South
		2NT	Pass
3♣	Pass	3♥	Pass
4NT	Pass	5♥	
All Pass			
5♥ by East			

Your partner's 2NT opener is 20-21 points and the 3♣ bid is Stayman.

You know of 33 points and you know of an 8-card ♥ fit. The math tells you that 6♥ should be a good slam but you might as well check Key-Cards, that's why the convention was invented. So you bid 4NT and partner answers 5♥.

You say "Darn!" You are missing just one Key-Card, but you are also missing the trump Queen. And with partner holding only a 4-card suit that Queen might well win a trick. Knowing that at best the slam will depend on a trump finesse you pass 5♥.

Board 3

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 5 3 2
♥ 4 3
♦ J 9 6 2
♣ A 7 6 4

♠ A K Q J

♥ A J 10 7

♦ A 5

♣ K Q 10



♠ 10 9 8 6 4

♥ 6 2

♦ 10 8 3

♣ J 5 2

♠ 7

♥ K Q 9 8 5

♦ K Q 7 4

♣ 9 8 3

With 11 points and a good suit you should make a positive response. So you bid 2♥. Partner then says 4NT. What is your bid?

The 4NT bid agrees ♥s as trump. You have one Key-Card, the ♥K, so you bid 5♣. Partner bids the ♥ slam.

West	North	East	South
	2♣	Pass	2♥
Pass	4NT	Pass	5♣
Pass	6♥		
All Pass			
6♥ by South			

Board 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ A Q J 7 5 3

♥ 6 5

♦ A 4 3

♣ 8 2

♠ 6 4

♥ J 7 2

♦ J 10 5 2

♣ A 10 9 3



♠ K 10

♥ A K 9 8 4

♦ K Q 8

♣ K Q 6

♠ 9 8 2

♥ Q 10 3

♦ 9 7 6

♣ J 7 5 4

West

1 ♠

3 ♠

5 ♠

All Pass

6 ♠ by West

North

Pass

Pass

Pass

East

3 ♥

4NT

6 ♠

South

Pass

Pass

The bidding has been as shown.

Your partner has shown a minimum opening hand, but with 6 ♠s. You are happy with the 8-card trump fit but need to know about Key-Cards. So you bid 4NT. Partner answers 5 ♠ and it is your bid again.

Partner has two Aces and the ♠Q. That should be all he needs to make slam so you bid 6 ♠.

Board 5

South Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 10 9 8

♥ 7 2

♦ 3 2

♣ K Q J 10 5 4

♠ 7 6 4 2

♥ K J 9 8 5

♦ K Q 7 4

♣ -



♠ 5 3

♥ 6

♦ 10 9 6 5

♣ A 9 8 6 3 2

♠ A K Q J

♥ A Q 10 4 3

♦ A J 8

♣ 7

With 11 points and a good suit you should make a positive response. So you bid 2♥. Partner then says 4NT. What is your bid?

The 4NT bid agrees ♥s as trump. You have one Key-Card, the ♥K, but you also have a void in ♣s. You therefore answer 6♣. Partner goes all the way to 7♥.

*West**North**East**South*

Pass

2♥

Pass

4NT

Pass

6♣

Pass

7♥

All Pass

7♥ by North

Board 6

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ K 6 5 2
 ♥ A Q 7 4
 ♦ K 8 6
 ♣ A Q

♠ 4 3

♥ 9 8 6

♦ 5 4 2

♣ 10 9 7 4 3



♠ A 10 9 7

♥ K J 10

♦ Q J 10 3

♣ K J

♠ Q J 8

♥ 5 3 2

♦ A 9 7

♣ 8 6 5 2

*West**North**East**South*

2♣

Pass

2♠

Pass

4NT

Pass

5♣

Pass

5♦

Pass

5♠

All Pass

5♠ by East

The bidding has been as shown.

Partner has 15-17 points and 4 ♠s. You have 18 points and 4 ♠s. You plan to bid the slam, but first you check Key-Cards. So you bid 4NT. Partner says 5♣.

You are missing 1 Key-Card. Slam has become less certain. You decide to see if partner has the trump Queen so you bid 5♦. Partner bids 5♠. What do you say next?

Partner denies having the ♠Q. Knowing that the best you could hope for would be a finesse to make the slam you give up your quest and pass.